

Giving managers AI speed without surrendering production control

AI-ASSISTED DEVELOPMENT · ENGINEERING GOVERNANCE · INTERNAL TOOLS

20+

INTERNAL APPLICATIONS BUILT

2

MANAGER-BUILDERS

3.5 mo → <1 wk

COMPARABLE DELIVERY CYCLE

THE CHALLENGE

Two technically capable managers had years of business knowledge embedded in spreadsheets, reports, calculators, and operating procedures. Coding agents gave them a realistic way to turn that knowledge into dashboards and internal applications without waiting for a conventional development queue.

The opportunity was real, but so was the risk: generated code could expose sensitive operational data, introduce inconsistent architecture, or reach production before anyone had verified what it was doing.

THE APPROACH

I designed a governed environment that separated rapid experimentation from production authority.

- A structured manager interview captures the workflow and requirements before implementation begins.
- Protected data environments limit risk: initial ERP access was read-only, with later read/write work confined to a playground refreshed from source data.
- Shared authentication and detailed access controls avoid every internal app inventing its own security model.
- Business-domain guidance, atomic commits, readable change logs, testing, and engineering review make generated work inspectable.
- Production release remains manually controlled.

THE RESULT

The two managers have used the environment to create more than 20 internal applications and dashboards across warehouse, sales, accounting, and management workflows.

For one comparable internal application, delivery time fell from approximately 3.5 months to less than one week while production control remained with engineering.

WHY IT MATTERED

My role is not to replace engineering with AI. It is to create the boundaries and review process that let knowledgeable managers move quickly without quietly becoming production administrators.

The important innovation was not faster code generation. It was a system where the people who understand the business can build rapidly while engineering retains control of data, security, and production risk.

TECHNOLOGY

AI coding agents · OAuth-style authentication · ACLs · Source control · Protected ERP data · Testing · Production review



SPEED INSIDE THE GUARDRAILS; THE RELEASE ITSELF STAYS WITH ENGINEERING